Unit 7

Two Notes at Once

New: Right-hand thirds and sixths: reading two notes together

So far the right hand has played one note at a time. Now it plays two together. Two notes a third apart look like a little snowman on the staff: both on lines or both in spaces, one just above the other. Read the top note as the tune, and let the lower note come along with it.

What is new

Thirds

Line-line or space-space, touching: C-E, D-F, E-G. In a five-finger position you play them with fingers 1-3, 2-4 or 3-5.

Sixths

Further apart: one note on a line and the other in a space, with two lines between them, such as C-A or D-B. The hand stretches: thumb on the lower note, finger 5 on the upper one.

Which note is the tune?

The top note. Play it a little louder than the lower note, so the melody still sings.

Reading two notes

Don't read the two notes separately. Read the top note, then recognise the shape below it: a third (touching) or a sixth (wide).

Reading tips

1. In your scan, find the two-note chords and decide which fingers will play each one.
2. Keep both notes exactly together: drop the hand, not two separate fingers.
3. If a two-note chord trips you up, play only its top note and keep going.

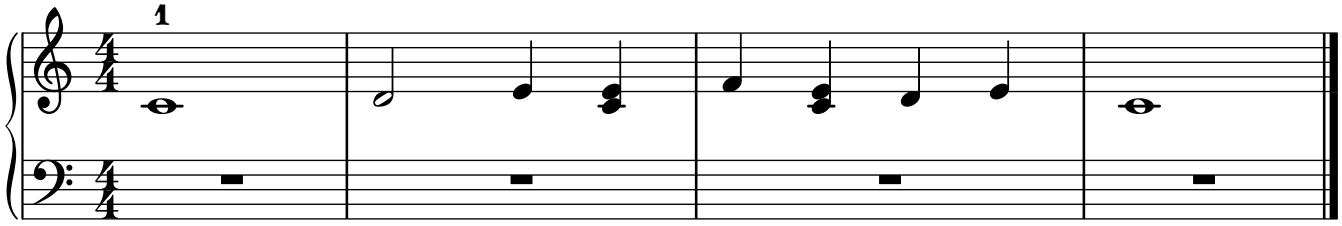
Part A: Thirds in the right hand ♩ = 56

Right hand alone in C position, with some thirds. Metronome 56.

☐ **7.1**



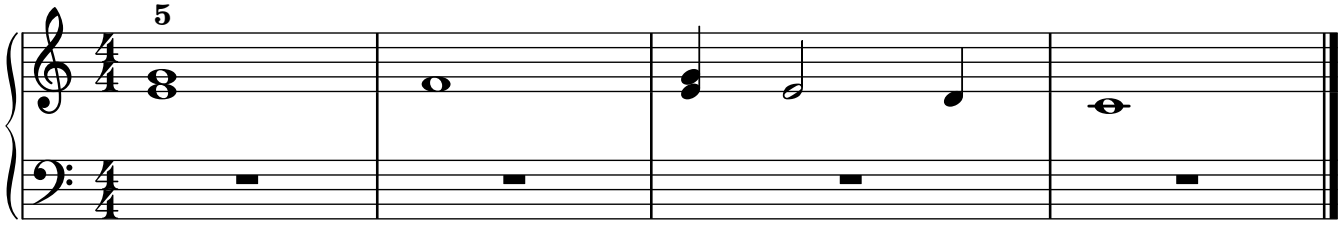
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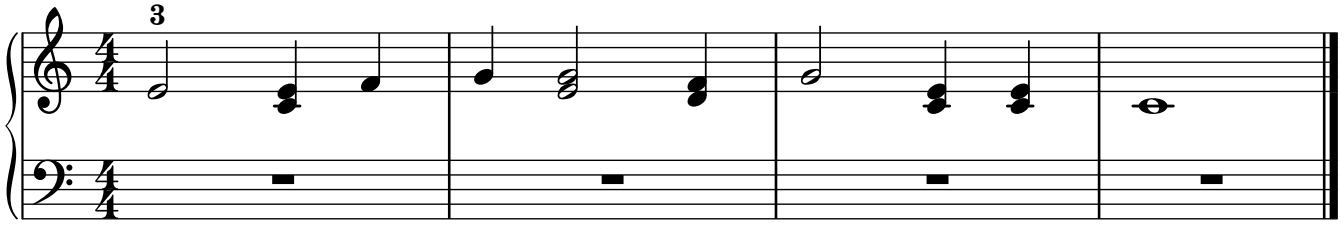
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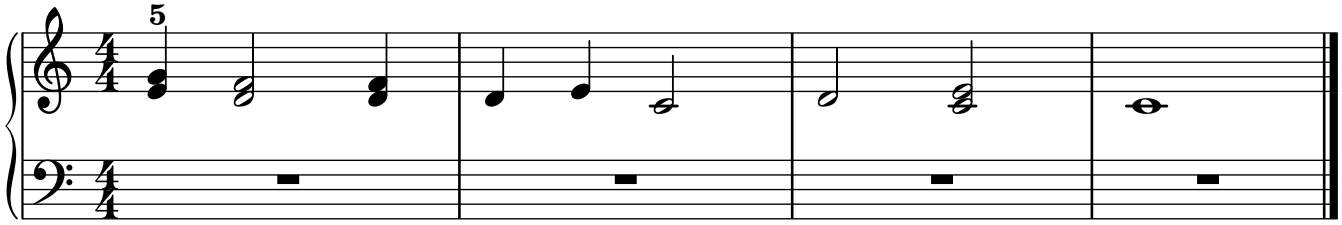
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☐ **7.5**



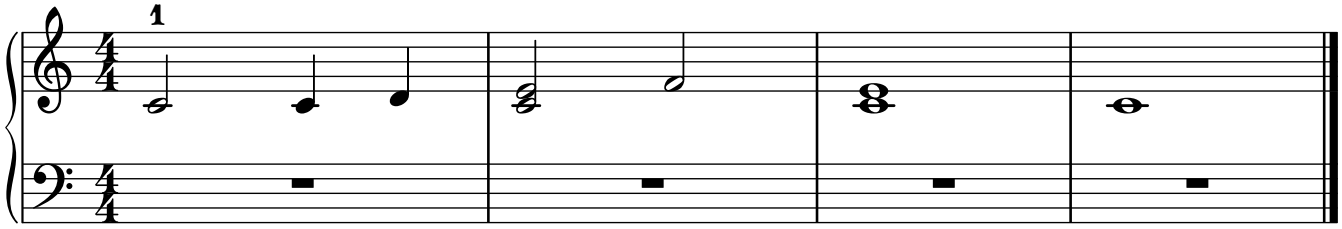
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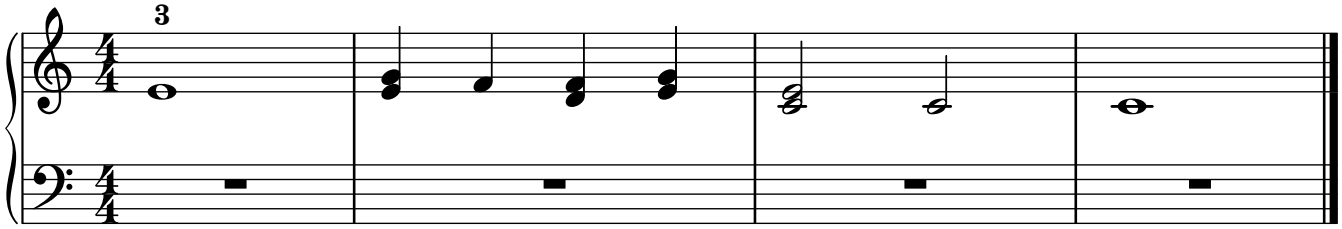
☐ **7.7**



☐ **7.8**



☐ **7.9**



☐ **7.10**



Part B: Thirds over broken chords

♩ = 60

Thirds over broken chords in C major.

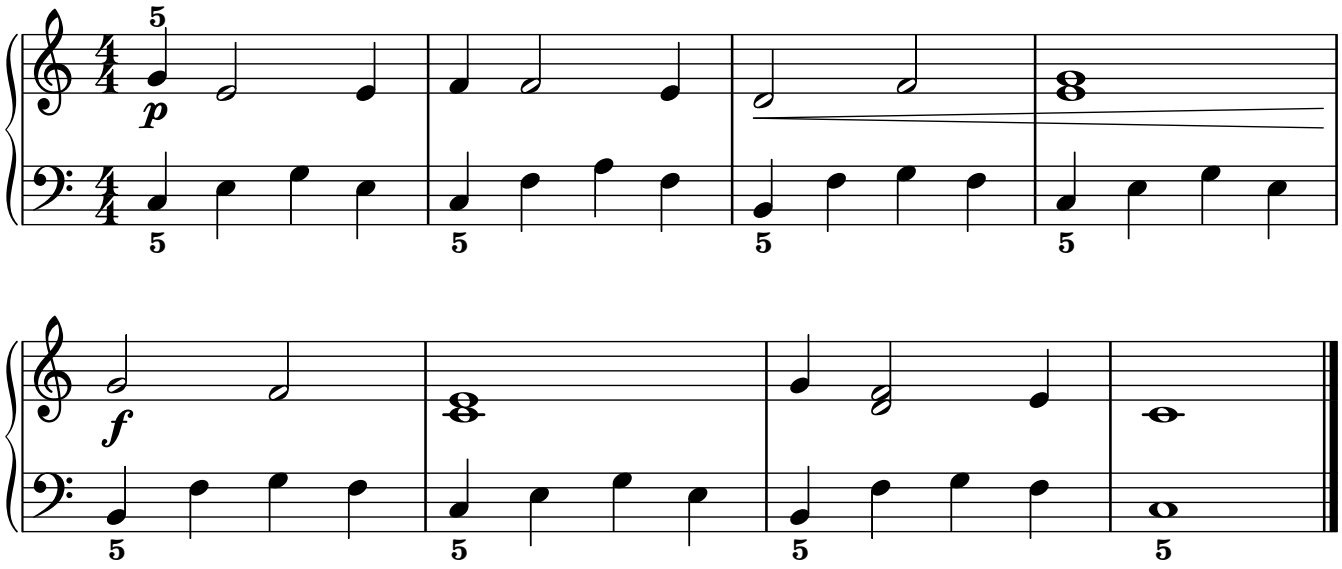
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☐ **7.12**



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7.14



7.15



7.16



7.17



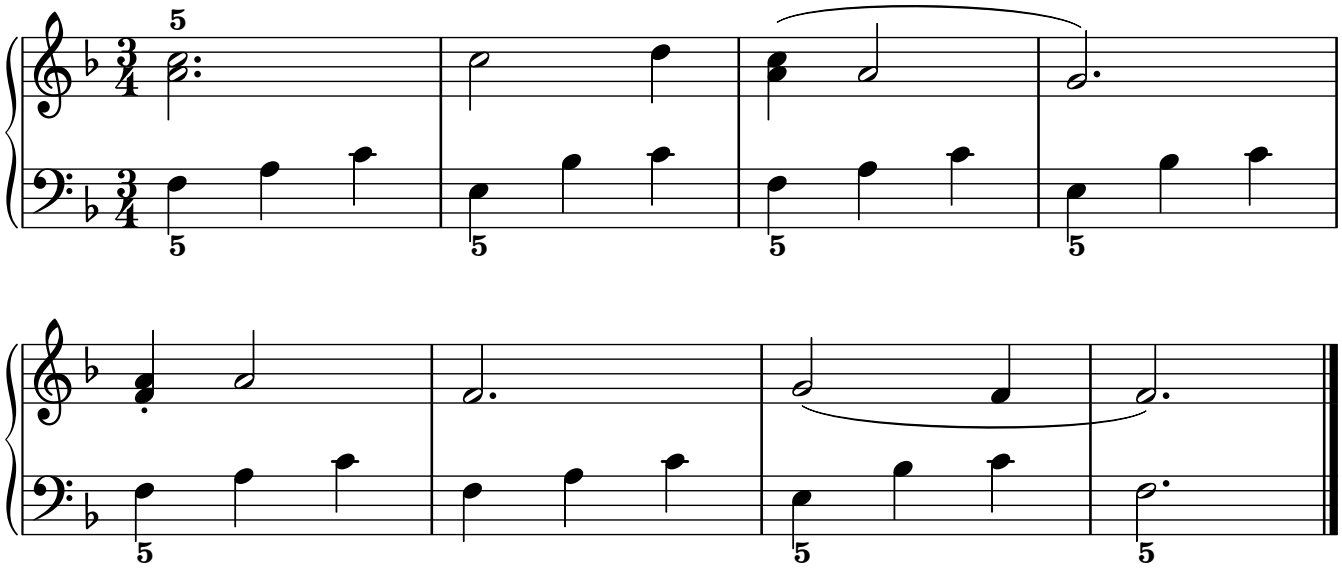
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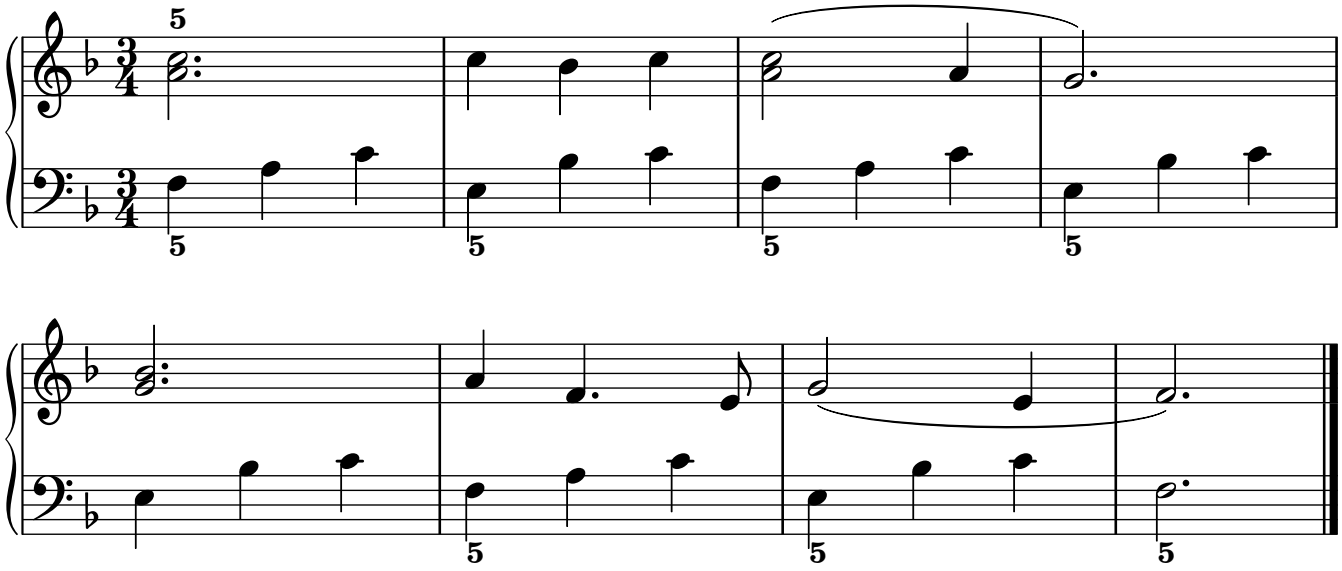
Part C: Thirds and sixths in F major ♩ = 69

F major in 3/4. The right hand stretches to E and D, which makes a few sixths possible.

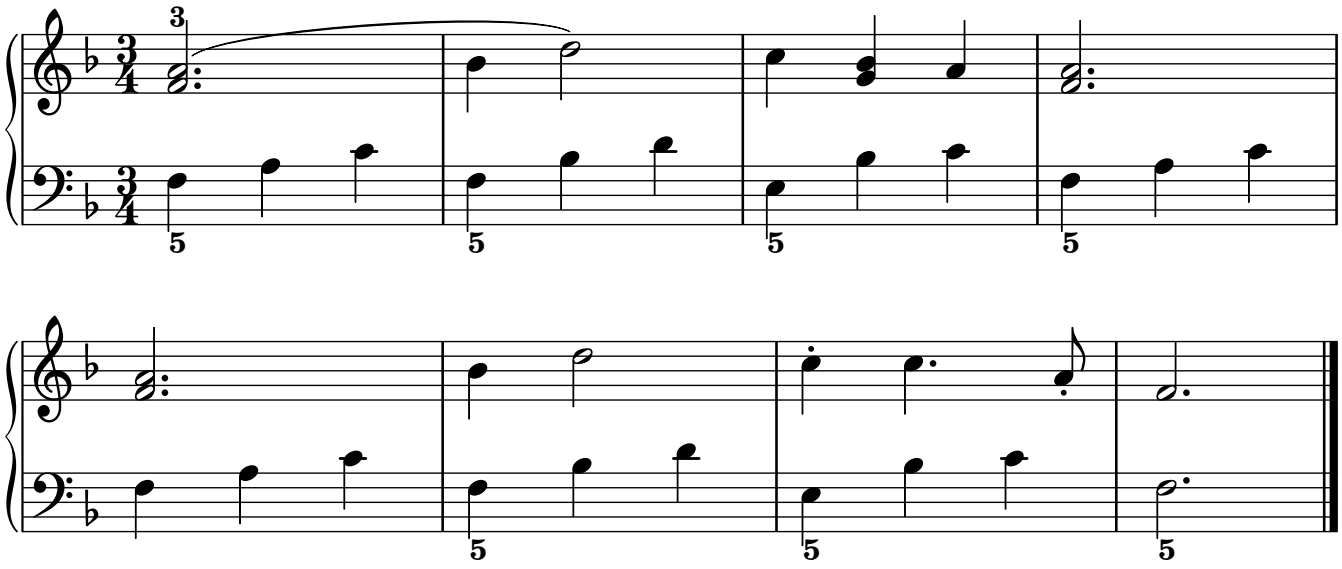
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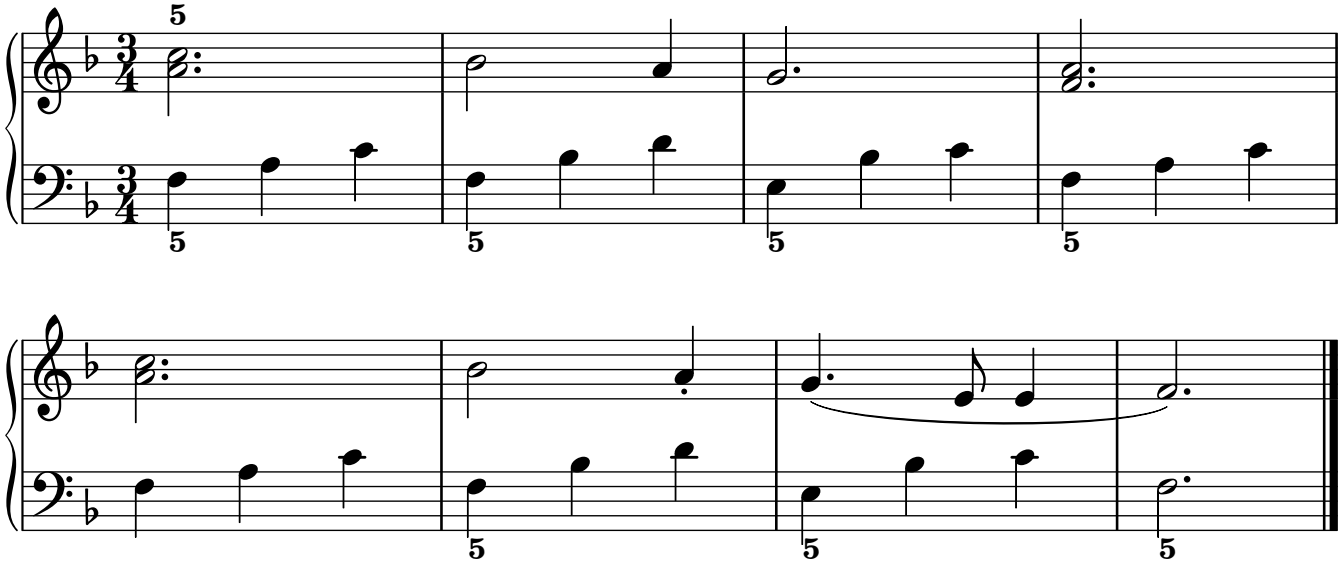
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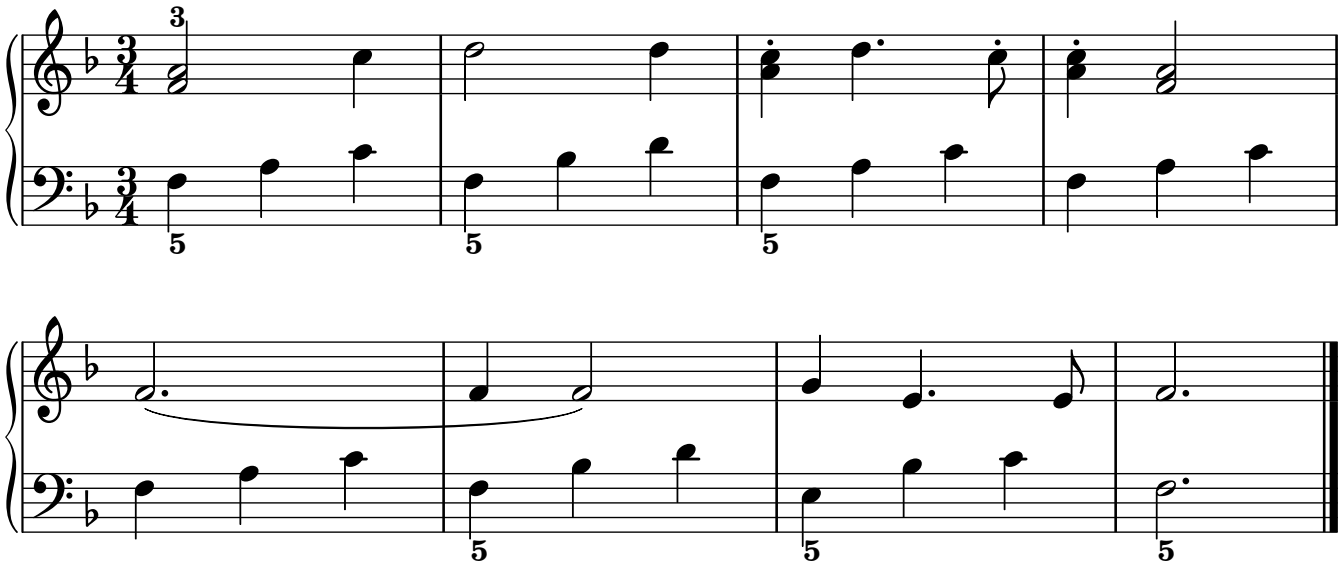
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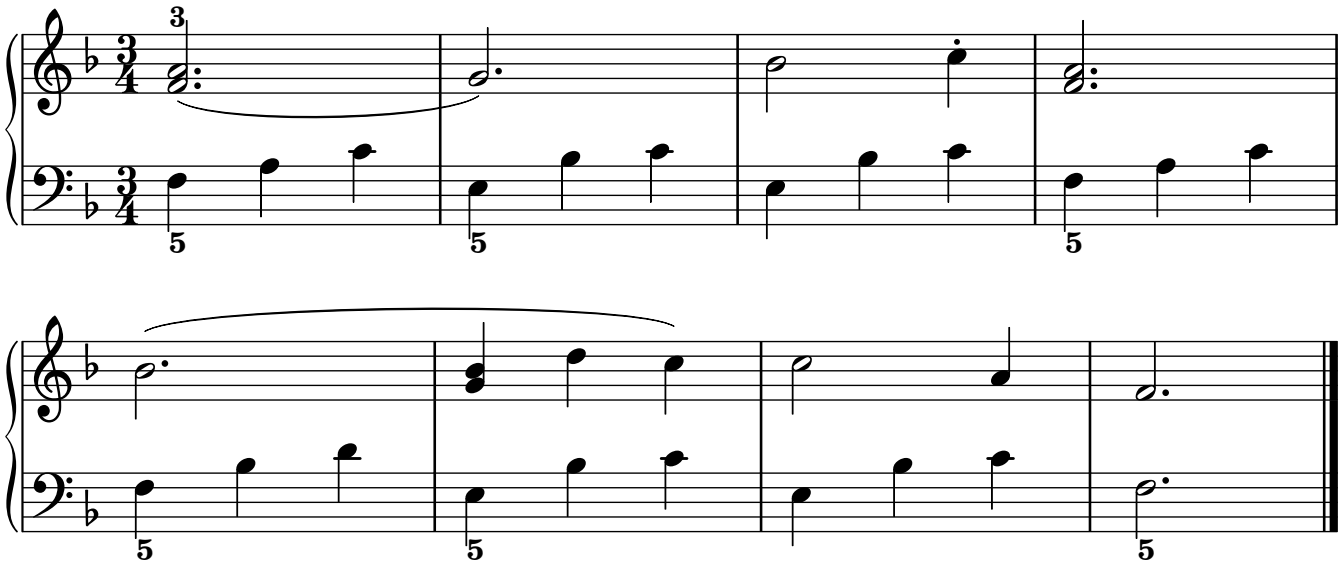
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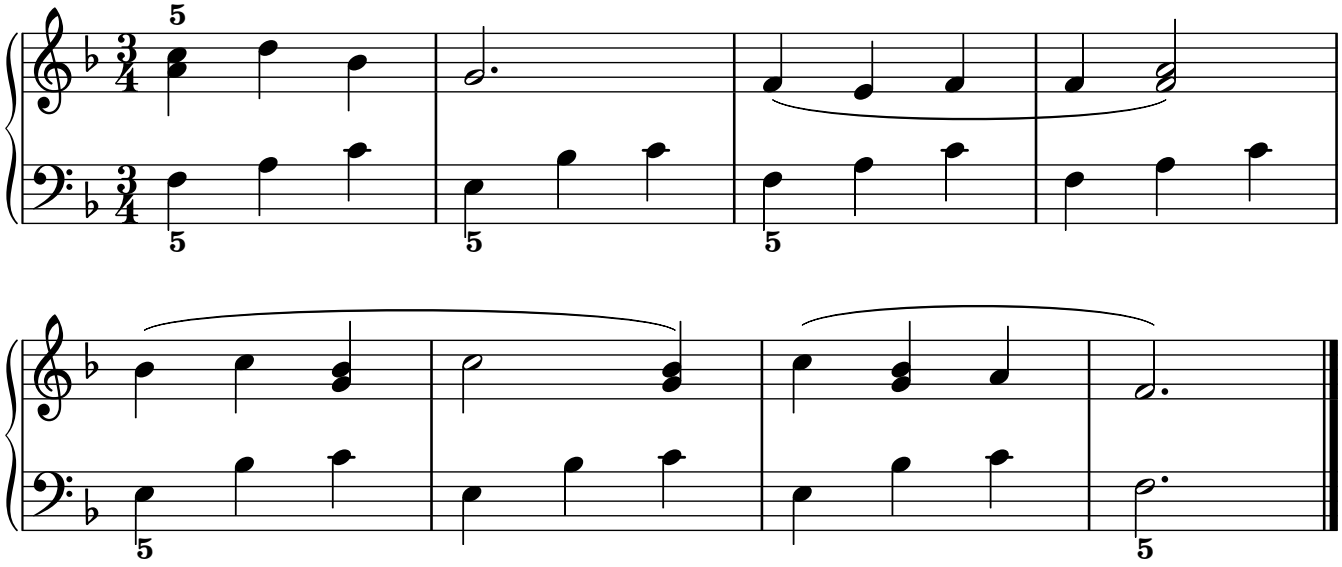
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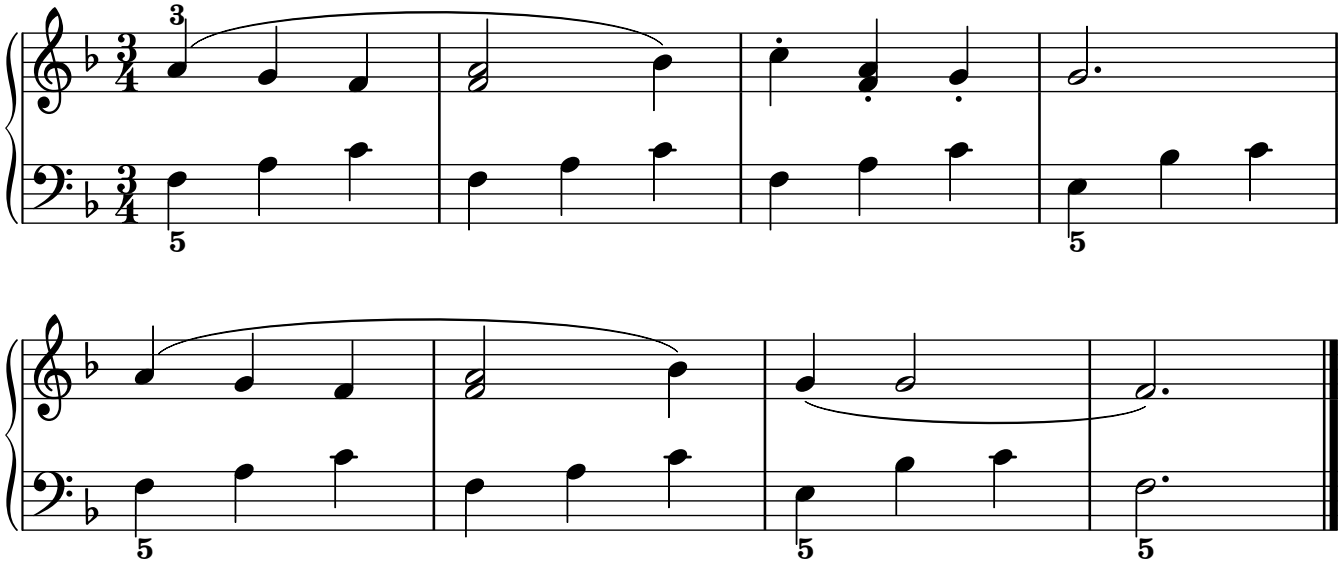
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☐ **7.25**



☐ **7.26**

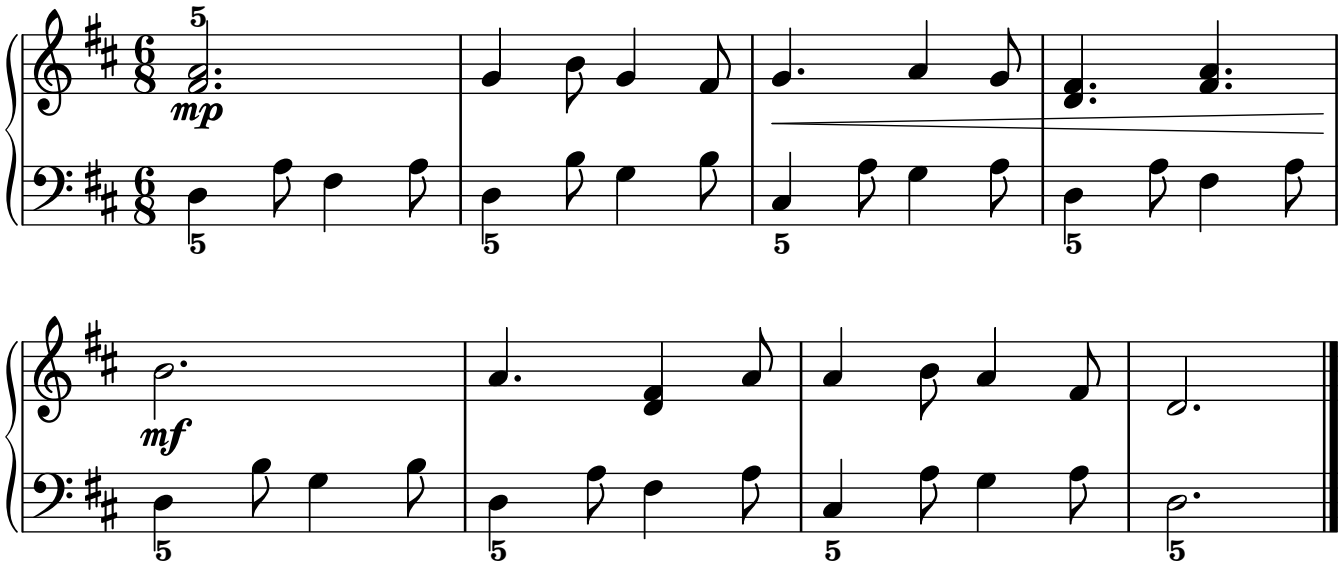


Part D: Two notes at once in 6/8

♩. = 50

D major in 6/8, with thirds and sixths.

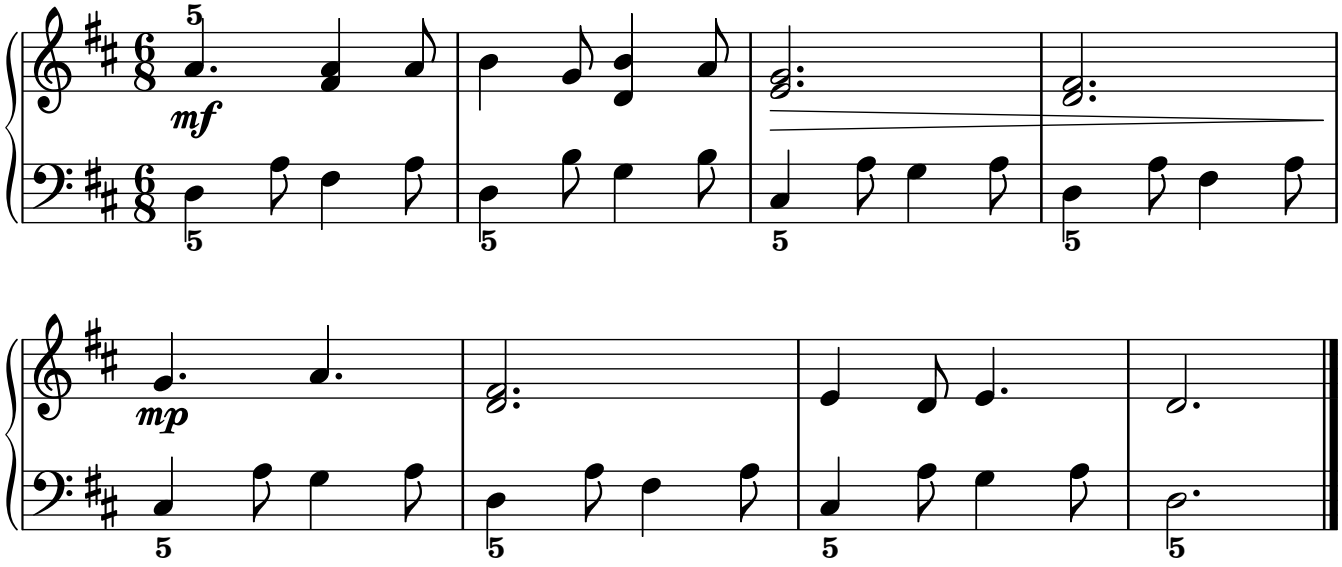
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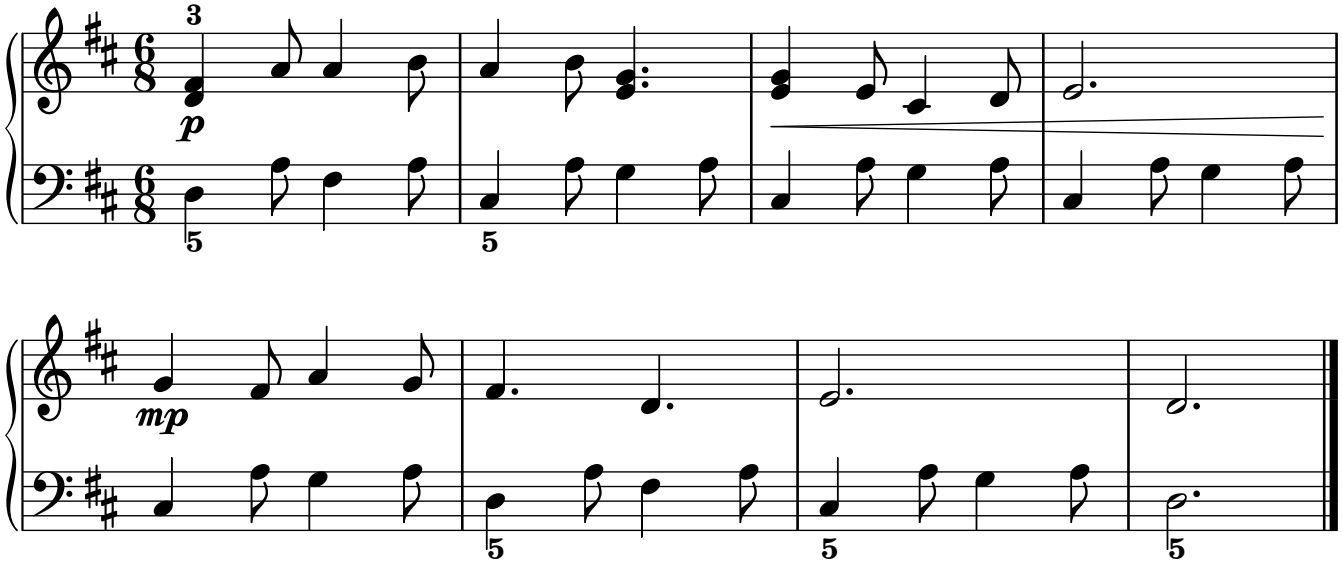
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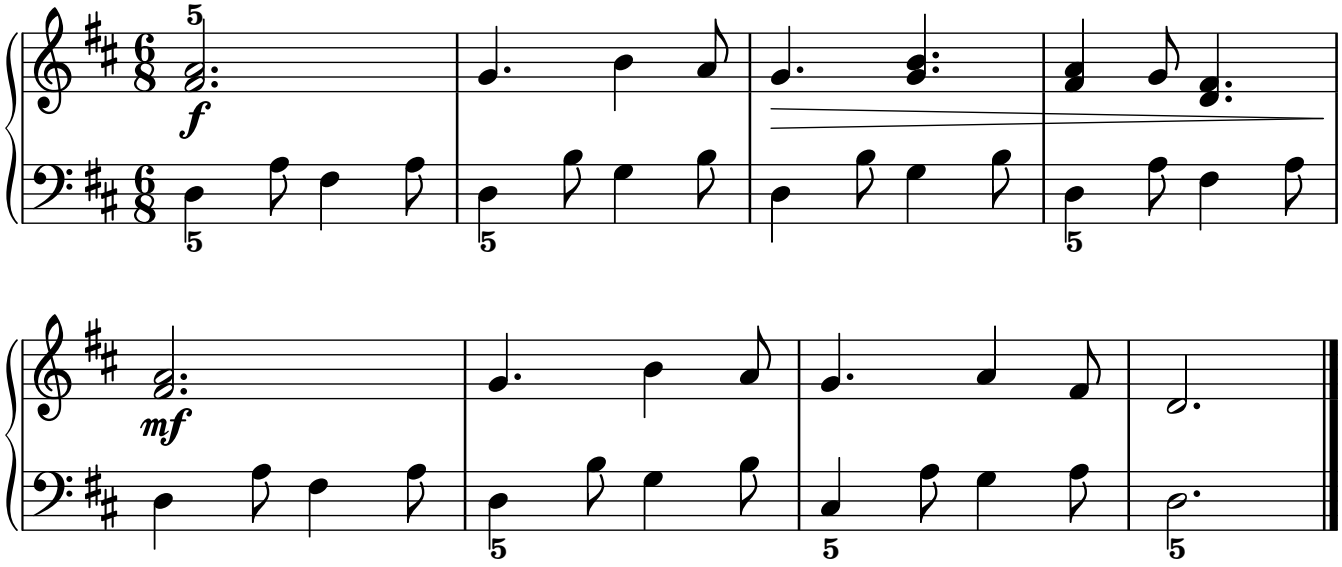
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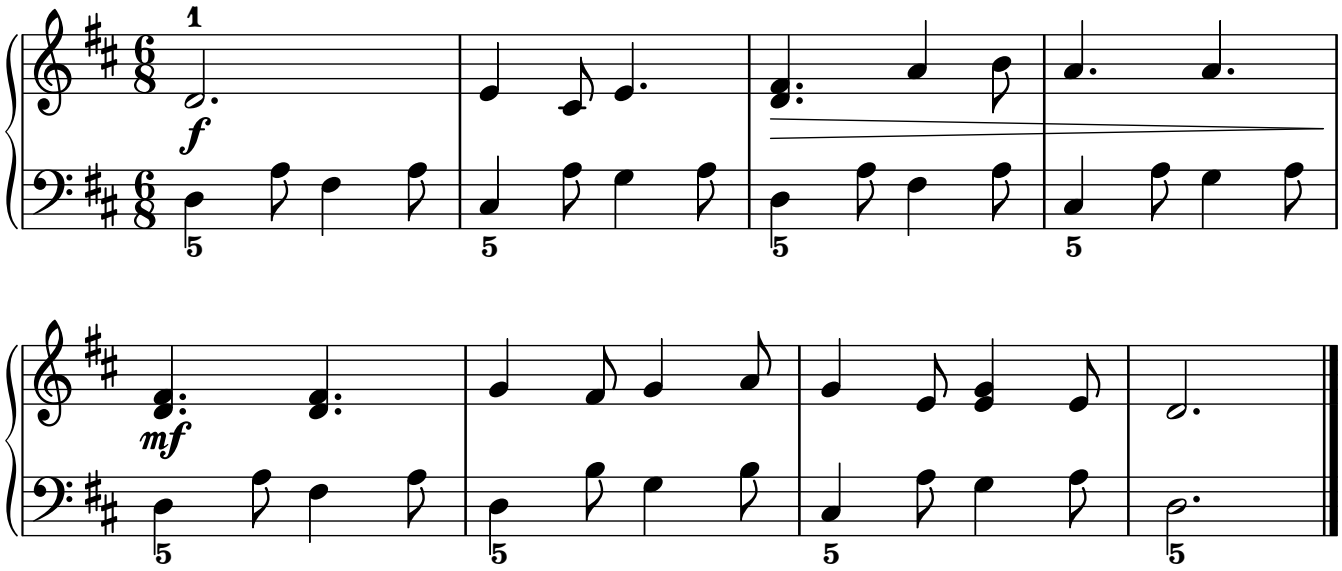
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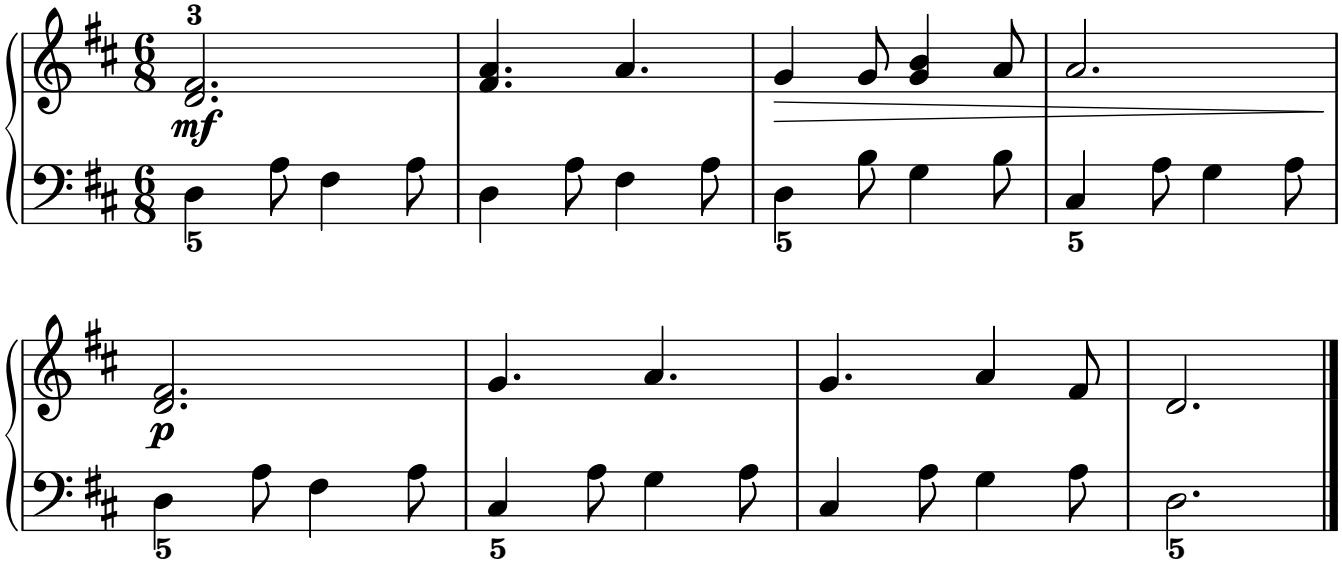
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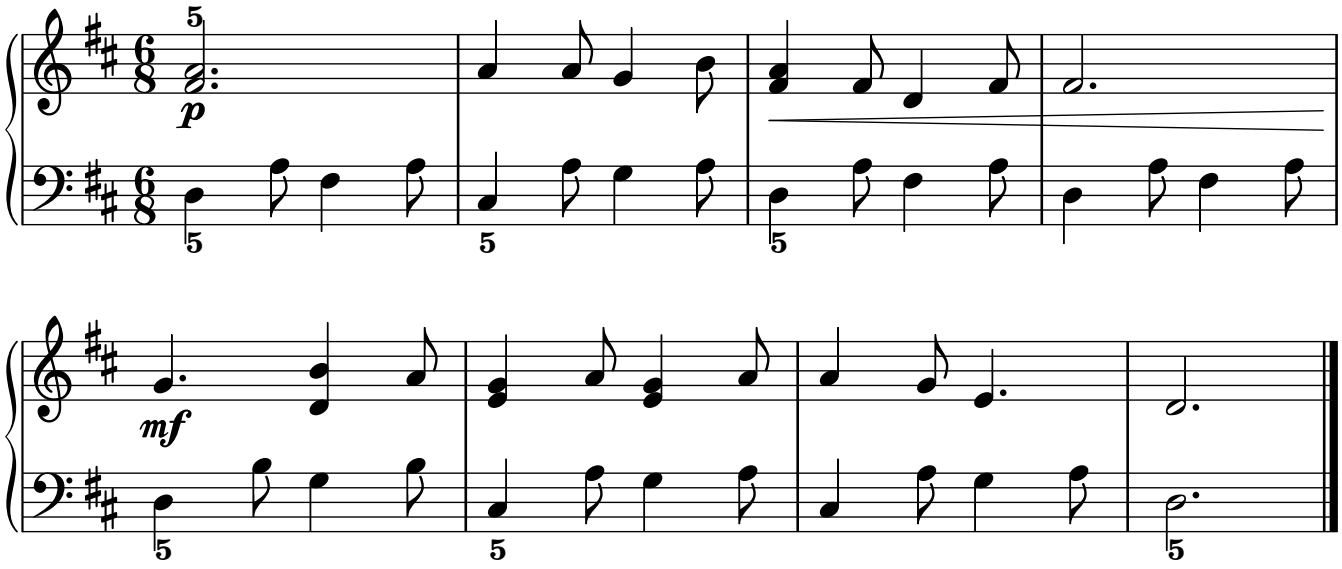
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7.34



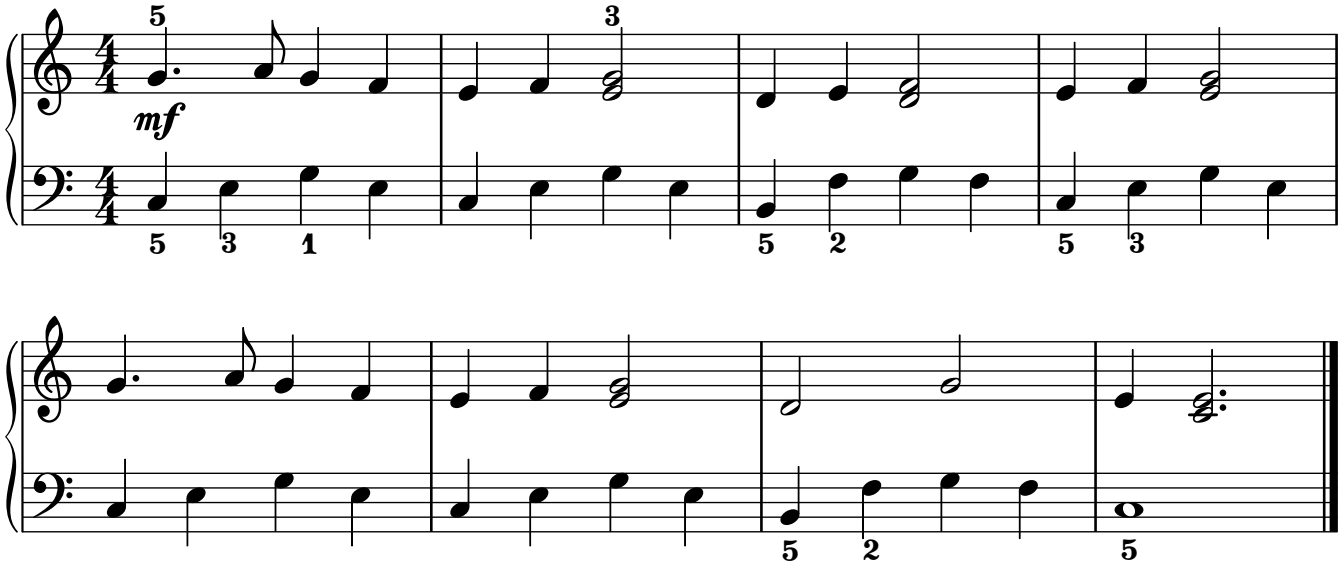
Pieces

Pieces are for playing more than once. Read each one first without stopping, like an exercise; then practise it until it sounds steady and musical.

London Bridge ♩ = 84

Traditional English nursery rhyme

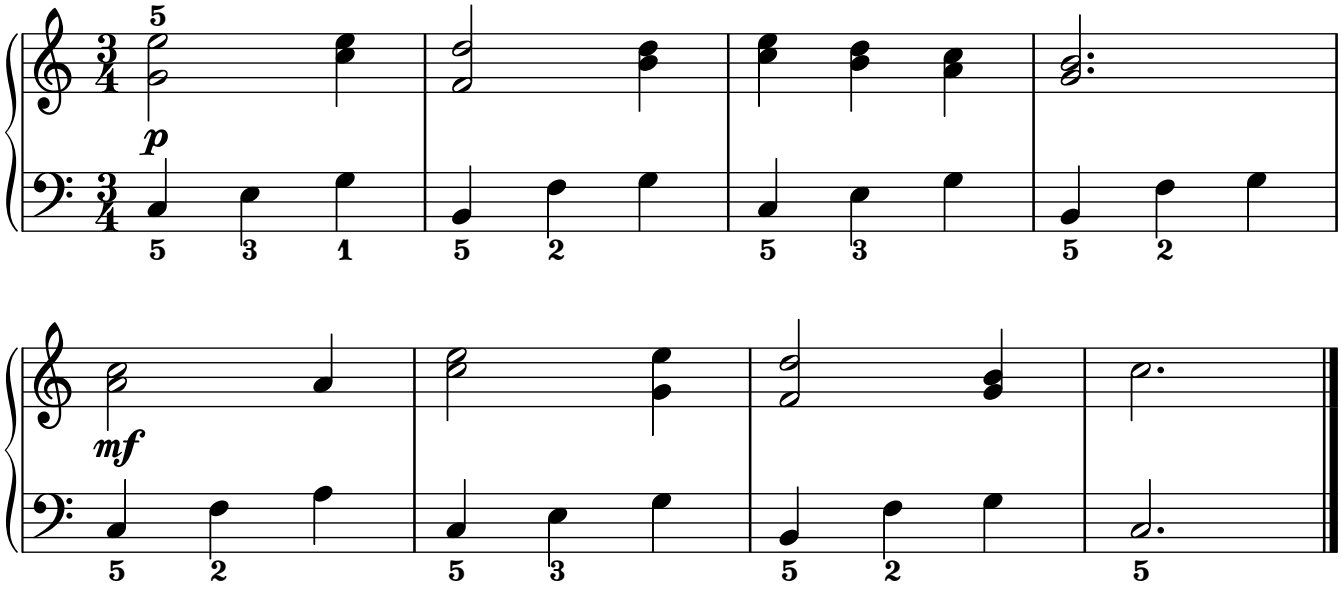
The long notes are doubled a third below. Play them with fingers 3 and 5 (E-G) or 2 and 4 (D-F), and keep the tune on top.



Two by Two ♩ = 76

Original

Thirds and sixths in G position. The sixths G-E (bars 1 and 6) and F-D (bars 2 and 7) need a stretch: thumb on the lower note, finger 5 on the upper one.



Barcarolle in D ♩. = 52

Original

A barcarolle is a boat song, in a gently rocking 6/8. The right hand plays thirds and three sixths: D-B in bars 2 and 6, C-sharp-A in bars 3 and 7.



Checkpoint: ready for Unit 8?

- Play five new exercises from Parts B to D at the speeds shown: at most one stop each, 9 notes out of 10 right.
- Both notes of every two-note chord sound together, and the top note sings.
- When you pass, move on to Unit 8.